

Jivahar Food Safety & Hygiene Manual

1. Introduction to Food Redistribution Safety

This manual outlines the core safety guidelines for donors, volunteers, and NGOs on the Jivahar platform. Ensuring food safety is the highest priority during donation, transportation, and redistribution to prevent foodborne illness.

2. Temperature Danger Zone Constraints

Bacteria grow rapidly in the temperature danger zone between 4°C (40°F) and 60°C (140°F). Hot cooked food must be kept above 60°C. Cold perishable food must be kept below 4°C. Perishable food left in the danger zone for more than 2 hours must be discarded. If ambient temperatures exceed 32°C, the safety window is reduced to 1 hour.

3. Perishable Food Storage and Shelf Life Guidelines

Cooked meals (rice, pasta, meat, vegetables) have a maximum shelf life of 4 hours at room temperature, or 3 to 4 days if stored in airtight containers under refrigeration (< 4°C). Raw meat must always be stored in the freezer below -18°C. Dairy items must be kept refrigerated at all times.

4. Visual and Sensory Inspection Protocols

Volunteers must execute a sensory check at pickup. Reject items if they exhibit: 1. Foul, sour, or rancid smell. 2. Visual indicators of decay (mold growth, discoloration, slime). 3. Damage to packaging (dents, leaks, broken seals, bulging cans).

5. Allergen Segregation and Declaration Rules

All donors must declare the presence of major allergens including dairy, peanuts, tree nuts, wheat, soy, eggs, fish, and shellfish. Allergen-containing foods must be packed in airtight containers with clear labeling, and physically separated during transportation to prevent cross-contact with allergen-free items.

6. High-Risk Reheating Policies

Any redistributed cooked food must be thoroughly reheated to a minimum internal temperature of 74°C (165°F) for at least 15 seconds within 2 hours before distribution to beneficiaries. Food must only be reheated once; any leftover reheated food must be composted.